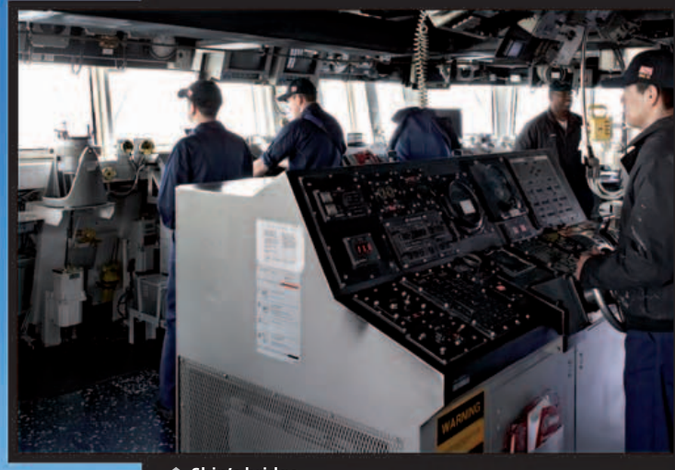


Mk45 gun and deckhouse
The 5in-gun on *Donald Cook*'s forward deck is the guided-missile destroyer's only large artillery weapon, designed for use against surface warships or aircraft, or for shore bombardment. The mast and deckhouse behind the gun bristle with radomes, antennas, jamming devices, and other types of navigational and electronic warfare equipment.



Ship's bridge
The helmsman steers the ship from the helm station in the center of the bridge. The ship also has an automated digital steering system, allowing a course to be entered and automatically maintained.



25-mm chain gun
Two Mk38 chain guns provide close-range defense against small surface threats such as hostile patrol boats or floating mines. The guns are manually aimed and operated and can fire up to 200 rounds per minute.





Anchor chain
This lightweight 4,000 lb (1,800 kg) anchor and the heavier 9,000 lb (4,000 kg) main anchor are both carefully positioned to stop them striking the large sonar dome on the hull as they are lowered.



Chaff and decoy launcher
The Mk36 Super Rapid Bloom Offboard Chaff (SRBOC) system can fire a range of chaff and infrared decoys to confuse hostile missiles and fire-control systems.



Phalanx weapon system
USS *Donald Cook* is fitted with two Phalanx Close-In Weapon Systems (CIWS) using automated radar-controlled 20-mm rotary cannon that can identify, track, and destroy incoming threats such as missiles.





Missile launch cells
The ship's two Vertical Launch Systems (VLS) can store and fire up to 90 Standard medium-range surface-to-air missiles, Tomahawk long-range cruise missiles, or ASROC anti-submarine missiles. In 2003 these launchers fired some of the first Tomahawk strikes of Operation Iraqi Freedom.